

Experiment – 5

Comparative Study of Popular No-Code and Low-Code Application Development Platforms

Aim

To study and compare popular No-Code and Low-Code application development platforms based on their features, development approach, and applications.

Objective

- To understand No-Code and Low-Code development.
- To study popular development platforms.
- To compare their features and uses.
- To identify suitable platforms for different application requirements.

1. Introduction

No-Code and Low-Code platforms allow applications to be developed faster using visual tools, drag-and-drop components, and pre-built services.

No-Code platforms are mainly designed for users with little or no programming knowledge.

Low-Code platforms allow visual development but also support custom coding when advanced features are required.

Basic Difference

No-Code	Low-Code
i) No programming required	ii) Limited programming may be required
i) Mainly visual development	ii) Visual development with custom code
i) Suitable for simple applications	ii) Suitable for more complex applications
i) Mainly for non-programmers	ii) Suitable for developers and technical users

2. Popular Platforms Studied

1. Bubble

Bubble is a popular **No-Code platform** mainly used for building web applications. It provides a visual editor for designing pages, workflows, databases, and user authentication.

Main Features:

- Drag-and-drop interface
- Workflow automation
- Built-in database
- User authentication
- API integration

Suitable for: Web applications and startup prototypes.

2. Glide

Glide is a **No-Code platform** used for quickly building simple web and mobile applications using data sources.

Main Features:

- Easy visual interface
- Data-based applications
- Pre-built components
- Quick application development

Suitable for: Internal tools, simple business applications, and data-based apps.

3. Microsoft Power Apps

Microsoft Power Apps is a **Low-Code platform** used for developing business applications, especially applications that integrate with Microsoft services.

Main Features:

- Visual application development
- Integration with Microsoft services
- Data connectivity
- Workflow support
- Custom logic

Suitable for: Enterprise and business applications.

4. Mendix

Mendix is a **Low-Code development platform** used for developing scalable web and enterprise applications.

Main Features:

- Visual development
- Reusable components

- API integration
- Collaboration tools
- Custom code support

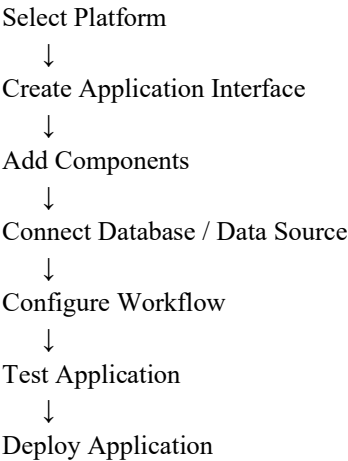
Suitable for: Large-scale business and enterprise applications.

3. Comparative Analysis

Platform	Type	Coding Level	Main Use	Suitable For
Bubble	No-Code	Not Required	Web Apps	Startups
Glide	No-Code	Not Required	Simple Apps	Internal/Data Apps
Power Apps	Low-Code	Limited	Business Apps	Enterprises
Mendix	Low-Code	Limited/Advanced	Enterprise Apps	Large Applications

4. Development Process

The general process followed while developing an application using No-Code or Low-Code platforms is:



The main advantage of this approach is that the development process can be completed faster compared to developing every component manually through programming.

5. Advantages and Limitations

Advantages	Limitations
------------	-------------

• Faster development	• Limited customization
• Less programming required	• Platform dependency
• Easy prototyping	• Complex applications may require coding
• Reduced development time	• Subscription costs may be involved
• Easy for beginners	• Limited control over system architecture

6. Result

The popular No-Code and Low-Code platforms were studied and compared. No-Code platforms such as **Bubble and Glide** are suitable for quickly developing simple applications, while Low-Code platforms such as **Microsoft Power Apps and Mendix** provide more flexibility for business and enterprise applications.

7. Conclusion

No-Code and Low-Code development platforms simplify the application development process by reducing the amount of manual coding required. No-Code platforms are suitable for beginners and rapid prototyping, whereas Low-Code platforms provide additional flexibility for developers. The selection of a platform depends on the application complexity, customization requirements, and target users.